



THE NORTHERN REACHES OF EUROPE are famous for their long, cold, dark winters, and contrastingly brief summers in which the sun barely, or never, sets. People living in these regions owe their

SCANDINAVIANS

EUROPE'S NORTHERNERS

The Holmenkollen Ski Jump is a Norwegian institution and home to an annual competition that first took place in 1892.



GETTING AROUND

Cross-country skiing was invented centuries ago in Scandinavia as a practical means of getting around in a snowy climate. It is still a popular sport today, particularly in Norway.



ICE FISHING

Even when the ice is solid enough to sit on, life continues beneath the surface. This warmly dressed Norwegian woman lying on a bearskin has drilled a hole into the thick ice covering a lake and is waiting patiently for the fish to bite.

What's in a name?

The term "Scandinavia" does not have a strict definition.

Geographically speaking, the Scandinavian peninsula consists of Norway, Sweden, and a bit of Finland, though the term is more commonly used to refer to Norway, Sweden, and Denmark. The broadest definition, however, also includes Iceland and Finland.

CHURCHBOAT RACES

Church services in the Swedish village of Rattvik attracted people from across the bay, some of whom traveled by boat. A custom evolved with the villages building longboats and racing one another. Today, the races are staged for the benefit of tourists.



SANTA LUCIA

December 13 is Santa Lucia Day.

Traditionally, in Sweden and Norway, the youngest daughter in each family brings breakfast to her parents dressed in a white dress, red sash, and candle headdress. The name Lucia means "light," a welcome sight in the long, dark winters.

